

DAVID CARLTON ADAMS

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U.S. citizen; authorized to work in the United States without sponsorship; eligible for clearance.

Summary

Program operator and co-founder: co-created a commissioning organization (2024, now incorporating as a 501(c)(3)), co-directed a nonprofit festival for six years on a single public-funder recompetes, and co-leads a creative program inside two Washington, DC correctional facilities. Builds and operates a multi-agent AI system with a human approval gate at every outbound channel, measured by health metrics designed and audited on a fixed rotation. Explains the same system to faculty, executives, and engineers: leads the AI-in-practice strand of a faculty learning community and sets up AI tooling for non-technical adopters.

Programs, Convenings & Talent Development

New Uncertainty Collective — *Co-founder, 2024–Present*

Co-founded and co-lead a commissioning, presenting, publishing, and recording organization from zero: built the initial network, developed institutional partnerships (Peabody Institute; NYU GSAS, in a concert series led by a co-founder), and have co-run **~10 public events since 2024**. Leading the 501(c)(3) legal standup (in process with DLA Piper) alongside programming, finance, and project-management operations, including custom agentic infrastructure, now live.

Project Poetic Justice (now under New Uncertainty Collective) — *Co-lead, 2026; Team member, founding cycle 2025*

Multi-week creative program inside two Washington, DC correctional facilities: every session, person, and object clears DOC security first. Joined the founding cycle as a team member, then co-led the second cycle after the program moved under NUC's umbrella; now represent it publicly, including JHU's *Rooted in Baltimore* exhibitor day (Sep 2026). Program record: **~24 original works premiered** across the two cycles, co-created with incarcerated writers, performed inside and for DC audiences.

Fast Forward Austin (501(c)(3)) — *Co-director, 2017–2023*

Six years of end-to-end program leadership for an annual new-music festival, a convening of regional and visiting artists run with no staff: grant strategy, budgets, venue contracting, artist logistics, live sound, volunteer coordination, across seven documented productions. Ran operations alongside a founding director in year one, then carried the organization as lead until relocating and recruiting two successor co-directors. Won renewal of the City of Austin's competitive annual grant every year (the Cultural Arts contract supplied **94–100%** of a **\$6,000–\$7,000** annual budget with no staff or overhead line) while holding artist payout at **73–81%** of every dollar spent every year on record.

Faculty Learning Community: AI, Artistry, and Education — Peabody Institute, Johns Hopkins University — *Co-lead, 2026–27*

Co-designing and co-leading a year-long faculty cohort program with two colleagues; lead the *AI in Practice* strand.

AI Systems Work — *independently built and operated*

Multi-agent operations platform — *architect and operator, 2026–Present*

Designed and operate a self-administered multi-agent system composing calendar, task, and external research/opportunity feeds into a daily briefing and a detailed project-management system (78 tracked projects, decision queue, audit log, all built in-house): **176 days of briefings delivered since March 2026**, no human assembly step. Runs **29 scheduled autonomous processes** across launchd/cron.

Designed the system's health metrics (stale pointers, silent lanes, unpushed state, drift between plan and code), scheduled the detectors that compute them, and keep a dated failure log. Review and merge changes to scheduled code as pull requests (136 since August 2026), backed by 54 test suites that run nightly.

AI governance and trust-boundary architecture — *designed and run it, 2026–Present*

Built tiered autonomy for a system reading untrusted sources (scraped reports, agent output, inbound email) and writing to outbound channels: read-only holds on untrusted input, human approval gates at every external boundary, rotating integrity audits on a 7-week lane rotation. Adversarial evaluation: had a second model attack the design; the holes it found became hook-enforced rules, not guidelines. Thirteen dated failure-and-fix episodes documented as a case study, each tied to its commit.

Other Work Experience

Peabody Institute, Johns Hopkins University — Baltimore, MD

Adjunct Faculty, Music Theory (Fall 2026); *Graduate Teaching Associate* (2024–2026); *Graduate Assistant* (2020–2024)

Instructor of record across five undergraduate theory terms (54 students taught).

Adjunct Faculty, Towson University — musicianship | *Fall 2024*

Music Program Director, International School of Texas — founding-year IB MYP program design and delivery, ~20 students | *2019–2020*

Research & Writing

- **Doctoral research**, Johns Hopkins University (2022–2026): analyzed the stylistic and institutional boundaries between experimental rock and contemporary classical music.
 - **Funded proposals and reporting**: City of Austin Cultural Arts (multi-year awards), Peabody Professional Development Grants (2021, 2023, 2026).
 - **Fulbright research proposal** (Germany, 2024–25): authored and selected as national semi-finalist.
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Education

Doctor of Musical Arts in Composition, cognate in Computer Music — Peabody Institute, Johns Hopkins University, 2026

Master of Music in Composition — Peabody Institute, Johns Hopkins University, 2022

Bachelor of Music in Composition — University of Texas at Austin, 2014

Coursework in mathematics, physics, chemistry, nuclear engineering — Texas A&M, 2001–02

Tools & Languages

Documents & data: Google Workspace (Docs, Sheets, Slides) including the Workspace APIs; Microsoft Excel and PowerPoint; relational project state with audit log (JSON; Python query tooling), built in-house.

AI & light programming: Claude Code and Claude API multi-agent design; MCP integrations; evaluation gates and guardrails; launchd/cron scheduling; reads and maintains Python and shell automation; Git.

Languages: English (native); French (professional working); Japanese (conversational); Russian (elementary).
